BST AT 1 – 2025 – Business Report on Alpha Athletic

Executive summary

- Overall, these were done well with students using a suitable (dot point) format
- Students decoded the question by elaborating on the directive verbs and specific syllabus dot points
- Also, the general BR format was logical and consistent throughout with students using headings and numbers.
- One area for improvement is suggesting how the influences impact ops influences and how the recommendations would improve performance objectives.

Role of operations

- The role of operations is board – it is the manufacturing and production hub of a business tasked with producing goods and services as efficiently, productively and to the highest quality suitable for the strategic role
- Strategic role for THIS business was most likely to be differentiation
- An area for improvement is for students to focus on differentiation from an operations point of view i.e. increasing the quality and variety of athleisurewear

Discuss influences on operations processes

- This was the weakest area across the cohort
- On the whole students did well to explain / describe the influence
- Students overlooked the directive verb (discuss for and against) and the IMPACT on operations processes
- Further consideration was required to the specific impact on inputs, transformation processes or outputs, or S&S and the 4Vs. How were the operations processes influenced.

Recommend outsourcing and supply chain management

- A mixed set of answers here, partly due to timing issues
- Recommend required x 2 reasons in favour of each strategy AND linked to the performance objectives.
- Stronger answers included well justified recommendations for Alpha Athletic, with comprehensive reasoning link to the objectives.
- Weaker answers, suggested a strategy but did not support this with evidence or an explanation of why it would be suitable
- Beware "lip service" by "name dropping" words without articulating the relevance

Self-Reflection, based on the examiners report above and your individual feedback comment below:

What did I do well in? 1 point

What will I do differently next time? 2 points